Simplifying rational expressions

ANSWER KEY

Core Concepts: Simplifying rational expressions

1 For the model $f(x) = 3x + 4$ in simplifying rational expressions, evaluate $f(2)$.

a. 10 ✓

b. 13

c. 6

d. 14

Substitute $x = 2$: $f(2) = 3(2) + 4 = 10$.

2 Find the positive solutions to the quadratic equation $x^2 - 4x + 3 = 0$.

a. $x = 1$ and $x = 4$

b. $x = 1$ **and** $x = 3$ ✓

c. $x = -1$ and $x = -3$

d. $x = 4$ and $x = 3$

Factoring $(x - 1)(x - 3) = 0$ yields the roots $x = 1$ and $x = 3$.

3 A data set recorded for simplifying rational expressions consists of the four values $\{10, 14, 18, 24\}$. What is the arithmetic mean?

a. 14.5

b. 15.5

c. 16.5 ✓

d. 18.5

The sum is $10 + 14 + 18 + 24 = 66$, and dividing by 4 gives 16.5.

Procedural Fluency & Algebraic Manipulation

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4 For the model $f(x) = 3x + 4$ in simplifying rational expressions, evaluate $f(3)$.

a. 13 ✓

b. 16

c. 9

d. 17

Substitute $x = 3$: $f(3) = 3(3) + 4 = 13$.

5 Find the positive solutions to the quadratic equation $x^2 - 6x + 8 = 0$.

a. $x = 2$ and $x = 5$

b. $x = 2$ **and** $x = 4$ ✓

c. $x = -2$ and $x = -4$

d. $x = 6$ and $x = 8$

Factoring $(x - 2)(x - 4) = 0$ yields the roots $x = 2$ and $x = 4$.

6 A data set recorded for simplifying rational expressions consists of the four values $\{10, 14, 18, 24\}$. What is the arithmetic mean?

a. 14.5

b. 15.5

c. 16.5 ✓

d. 18.5

The sum is $10 + 14 + 18 + 24 = 66$, and dividing by 4 gives 16.5.

Graphical & Geometric Interpretation

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7 For the model $f(x) = 3x + 4$ in simplifying rational expressions, evaluate $f(4)$.

a. 16 ✓

b. 19

c. 12

d. 20

Substitute $x = 4$: $f(4) = 3(4) + 4 = 16$.

8 Find the positive solutions to the quadratic equation $x^2 - 8x + 15 = 0$.

a. $x = 3$ and $x = 6$

b. $x = 3$ **and** $x = 5$ ✓

c. $x = -3$ and $x = -5$

d. $x = 8$ and $x = 15$

Factoring $(x - 3)(x - 5) = 0$ yields the roots $x = 3$ and $x = 5$.

9 A data set recorded for simplifying rational expressions consists of the four values $\{10, 14, 18, 24\}$. What is the arithmetic mean?

a. 14.5

b. 15.5

c. 16.5 ✓

d. 18.5

The sum is $10 + 14 + 18 + 24 = 66$, and dividing by 4 gives 16.5.

Exam-Style Problem Solving & Modeling

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10 For the model $f(x) = 3x + 4$ in simplifying rational expressions, evaluate $f(5)$.

a. 19 ✓

b. 22

c. 15

d. 23

Substitute $x = 5$: $f(5) = 3(5) + 4 = 19$.

11 Find the positive solutions to the quadratic equation $x^2 - 10x + 24 = 0$.

a. $x = 4$ and $x = 7$

b. $x = 4$ **and** $x = 6$ ✓

c. $x = -4$ and $x = -6$

d. $x = 10$ and $x = 24$

Factoring $(x - 4)(x - 6) = 0$ yields the roots $x = 4$ and $x = 6$.

12 A data set recorded for simplifying rational expressions consists of the four values $\{10, 14, 18, 24\}$. What is the arithmetic mean?

a. 14.5

b. 15.5

c. 16.5 ✓

d. 18.5

The sum is $10 + 14 + 18 + 24 = 66$, and dividing by 4 gives 16.5.

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